

iudgement seate, where I ought to be iudged: To the Iewes haue I no harme done, as thou very wel knowest.

11 For yf I had done any hurt, or committed any thyng worthy of death, I refuse not to dye: But yf there be none of these thinges, wherof they accuse me, no man may deliuer me to them. I appeale vnto ^(b) Caesar.

12 Then spake Festus, with the counsell, and answered: Hast thou appealed vnto Caesar: vnto Caesar shalt thou go.

13 And after certayne dayes, king Agrippa and Bernice came vnto Cesarea, to salute Festus.

14 And when they had ben there a good season, Festus rehearsed Pauls cause vnto the kyng, saying: * There is a certayne man left in bondes of Felix,

15 About whom, when I came to Hierusalem, * the hye priestes and elders of the Iewes enfourmed me, and desired to haue iudgement agaynst hym.

16 To whom I aunswere: It is not the maner of the Romanes, for fauour to deliuer any man that he shoulde perishe, before that he which is accused, haue the accusers before hym, and haue licence to aunswere for hymselfe, concerning the cryme layde agaynst hym.

17 Therefore, when they were come hyther, without any delay, on the morowe I sate to geue iudgement, and commaunded the man to be brought forth.

18 Agaynst whom, when the accusers stode vp, * they brought none accusation of such thynges as I supposed:

19 But had certayne questions agaynst hym of their owne superstition, and of one Iesus which was dead, whom

Paul affirmed to be alyue.

20 And because I doubted of such maner of questions, I asked hym whether he woulde go to Hierusalem, and there be iudged of these matters.

21 But when Paul had appealed to be kept vnto the knowledge of Augustus, I commaunded hym to be kept, tyll I myght sende hym to Caesar.

22 Then Agrippa sayde vnto Festus: I woulde also heare the man my selfe. To morowe sayd he, thou shalt heare hym.

23 And on the morowe, when Agrippa ^G was come, and Bernice, with great pompe, and were entred into the counsell house, with the chiefe captaynes, and chiefe men of the citie, at Festus commaundement was Paul brought forth.

24 And Festus sayde: Kyng Agrippa, and al men which are here present with vs, ye see this man, about whom all the multitude of the Iewes haue intreated me, both at Hierusalem, and also here, crying, that he ought not to lyue any longer.

25 Yet founde I nothyng worthy of death, that he had committed: Neuerthelesse, seeyng that he hath appealed to Augustus, I haue determined to sende hym:

26 Of whom I haue no certayne thyng to write vnto my Lorde. Wherefore, I haue brought hym forth vnto you, and specially vnto thee, O kyng Agrippa, that after examination had, I myght haue somewhat to write.

27 For me thynketh it vnreasonable, for to sende a prysoner, and not to shewe the causes which are laide agaynst him.

The xxvj. Chapter.

1 Kyng Agrippa heareth Paul. 25 Pauls modest aunswere agaynst the iniurie of Festus.

A



hen Agrippa sayde vnto Paul, thou art permitted to speake for thy selfe. Then Paul stretched forth the hande, and aunswere ^[for hym selfe]

2 I thynke my selfe happy, king Agrippa, because I shall aunswere this day before thee, of all the thynges whereof I am accused of the Iewes:

3 Namely, because thou art expert in all customes and questions, whiche are

among ^(a) the Iewes: wherefore I beseeche thee to heare me patiently.

4 My lyfe, that I haue led of a chyld, which was at the first among myne owne nation at Hierusalem, knowe all the Iewes,

5 which knewe me from the beginning, (yf they woulde testifie) that * after the most straytest sect of our ^(b) religion, I lyued a pharisee.

6 And nowe I stande and * am iudged, for the hope of the promise made of God vnto our fathers:

Vnto

(b) The iniquitie of the iudge, who contrarie to equitie, wplyng to pleasure the Iewes, desired howe to betray Paul, & drawe Paul to appeale, which is the bittermost remedy for such as by wrong iudgement are oppressed, and this appellation by Gods providence was a meane that Paul shoulde testifye of Christe at Rome also.

Act. xxvi. f

(a) He knew much, but he payed in the right applying of his knowledge, as they do which be wile in their owne conceits: so he, and haue the zeale of God, but not according to knowledge. (b) He taketh the sect of the pharisees to be perfectest, because their doctrine was better than the other sects. The Saducees denied the resurrection of the dead. The Essenes glozing in straggling of life, here regarded true doctrine.